Map Panel

🗺️ **What you can do here:** See your causal relationships as an interactive network map. Drag nodes around, click on links to edit them, and use the controls to customize how the map looks. You can even drag one factor onto another to quickly create new links. This is where your data comes to life visually.

Map Controls

- 👉 **Jump to factor** (type-to-search dropdown): quickly find and select factors on the map (supports multiple selections).
- 👉 **Refresh layout** (button): reset the map layout after zooming/moving.
- 👉 **Copy image to clipboard** (button): copy a high-quality map image for reports/slides.
- 👉 **Copy legend** (button): copy the map legend text.
- 👉 **Zoom in/out** (controls): zoom the map view.
- 👉 **Full screen** (button): expand the map to fill the whole window; click again or press Escape to return. You can still click factors and links to edit them while full screen. The same button appears on the Links, Factors, Projects and Sources tables.
- 👉 **Double-click** (gesture): zoom in to that point on the background.

Map Legend

Discrete text legend showing:

- projectname and included sources
- Citation coverage percentage
- Visual encoding explanations (link sizes, colors, numbers)
- Applied filters summary
  - 💡 Tip: Click Copy legend to copy this text to clipboard.
  - You can drag the legend box to reposition it on the map.

Evidence (shortcut to Links Print View)

- 👉 **Evidence** (button, bottom-right on the map, opposite the legend): switches to the **Links** tab and opens **Print View** for the **same filtered links** you see on the map. It applies a preset—**Group by** Bundle and Source, **sort** by citation count (highest first), **Show details** and **Context** on, **page size** 50—and updates the URL so you can bookmark or share that layout. A toast links to Print View help; a short hint may point to the **Print view** toggle.

Map Formatting

Customisable formatting (Things you can tweak)

Layout and interaction

- 👉 **Layout** (dropdown): choose how the map is laid out.
  - Interactive and most other layouts are good while you are conducting your research (fast + supports the interactive features).
  - Print/Graphviz is best for static images (reports/journal articles). In Graphviz SVG you can still pan/zoom (mouse wheel, double-click, Shift+double-click).
- 👉 **Groups** (dropdown): layout maps with top-level factors as boxes which group together their "children". Choose how group titles are extracted from factor text: No groups / Level 1 (;) / First colon (:) / Square brackets [] / Round brackets ().
- 👉 **Direction** (radio group): LR, RL, TB, or BT (for Interactive and Print/Graphviz layouts).
- 👉 **Link direction** (dropdown): Normal (directed arrows) vs Undirected (dots at both ends).
  - In Undirected mode, dots use the same colours as arrowheads (including sentiment colouring). When sentiment is neutral (0), they use **Link Colour**.
  - Note: when the Combine Opposites filter is active, tail/head can still have different colours.

Factors

- 👉 **Factor labels** (dropdown): what to show next to each factor (same data as the Factors Panel).
  - Citation count (default) / Source count / Sentiment (mean incoming) / None
- 👉 **Factor colours** (dropdown): Outcomeness (default) / Influence / **Sentiment discrepancy** (orange scale: how much the factor's incoming links disagree in sentiment) / Citation count (total, in, or out) / Source count (total, in, or out) / **Label segment** (full label or the same segment patterns as **Groups**) / None
- 👉 **Factor sizes** (dropdown): Citation count (default) / Source count / None
- 👉 **Label Width** (slider): how wide a factor label may run before it wraps onto another line. The width is measured in **pixels**, not characters, and runs from 30px at the far left to 800px at the far right on a logarithmic scale, so equal steps make bigger jumps at the top end. The number under the slider is the width it currently means. This is the main control for the shape of the whole map: a **narrow** width wraps labels onto more lines, making factors tall and the map tall and thin; a **wide** width keeps labels on one line, making the map short and wide. So to get a taller map, move this slider **down**, not up. **Tidy** (below) sets this slider for you unless you turn it off.

Spacing (Print / Graphviz layout) {#map-spacing}

- 👉 **H-Gap** and **V-Gap** (sliders): one sets the gap between the levels of the map, the other the gap between factors on the same level. Which is which depends on **Direction**, so the two labels swap when you change it: the slider marked with the horizontal arrows always changes horizontal spacing. In LR and RL the levels run left to right; in TB and BT they stack top to bottom.

- 👉 **Tidy** (tick box, on by default): sets **Label Width**, **H-Gap** and **V-Gap** for you. It aims to make the factor labels as large as they can be on screen while the arrows stay easy to follow, which usually also leaves the map with roughly the same proportions as the pane it sits in.
  - To change the proportions it fits to, drag the map pane's separator bar so the pane is wider or taller. The map tidies itself again.
  - To set the spacing yourself, drag any of those three sliders. That unticks Tidy and your settings stay put. Tick it again to hand control back.
  - Where a map's arrows leave their factors very steeply and bunch into a bundle, Tidy pushes the levels further apart, and it will accept smaller labels to do so, but only while the labels stay readable. On a bigger map, where spreading the levels would shrink the labels too far, Tidy leaves the arrows steeper and says so under the tick box.
  - On a map with too many factors to read with all of it in view, Tidy keeps the standard spacing, which reads best when you zoom in, and says so under the tick box. Filter the map down and Tidy fits it again.
  - Some maps cannot be improved much. A long single chain, or a set of factor pairs with nothing joining them, will not sit well in a pane whatever the spacing.
  - On a big map, Tidy stands aside when a single layout of the map takes more than a second and a half, or when the map is too large for it to measure, and the line under the tick box says so. Filter the map down and Tidy starts again by itself, or untick it and set the spacing by hand. Ticking it again makes it try once more.

Links

- 👉 **Link labels** (dropdown): what to show on each link.
  - Citation count (default) / Source count / Sentiment / Label by Group / Unique Sources / All Sources / Unique Tags / Unique Tags (Tally) / All Tags / None
- 👉 **Link widths** (dropdown): Citation count (default) / Source count / None
- 👉 **Link label font size** (control): change link label font sizes.
- 👉 **Arrowhead size** (control): scale arrowhead size (Interactive + Print/Graphviz). Default 100% keeps current appearance.
- 👉 **Link colour** (colour picker): sets the default link line colour (Interactive + Print/Graphviz). When sentiment is neutral (0), this colour is also used for arrowheads and node borders.
- 👉 **Links highlight** (dropdown): optional extra "halo" highlighting without changing the base colour scheme.
  - Off (default)
  - Reverse (backwards/same-rank in current layout direction)
  - Significant (when Label by Group shows ⬆/⬇)
  - Feedback loop (2 / ≤3 / ≤4 factors)
  - Feedback loop + reverse (combine the above)

Other

- 👉🏽 **Show self-loops** (toggle, default on): show/hide A→A links on the map.

> **Why a factor's number can look bigger than its arrows add up to.** A self-loop is a link from a factor back to itself (for example a "plain coding" that just records "this theme is present"). When both factor numbers and link numbers are set to citation count, a self-loop is counted on its factor **twice**: once as a citation going out of it, once as a citation coming into it. But on the map that self-loop is drawn as a single looping arrow with a single number. So if you add up the numbers on a factor's arrows by eye, any factor that has a self-loop comes out higher than you expect. This is normal and correct: it is the standard way graphs count connections (a self-loop adds one to both the factor's "in" tally and its "out" tally). If you do not want self-loops counted this way, turn off **Show self-loops**, or use the Exclude self-loops filter.

Fixed visual appearance (things you can't tweak)

Some parts of the map's appearance are automatic (i.e. they are not controlled by the Map Formatting widgets above):

Leading emoji (Print / Graphviz only):

- If a factor label starts with an emoji, the **Print (Graphviz)** SVG post-process moves that emoji to a larger symbol offset near the top of the node and removes it from the inline label text (trivial matches like lone digits are left inline). **Interactive** layout keeps the full label, including any leading emoji, in the normal label position.

Link geometry (bundling):

- Links are bundled and drawn as curved edges for readability.

Automatic colouring overlays:

- Arrowhead colours reflect mean **sentiment** for that link bundle (neutral uses your chosen **Link colour**).
- When the Combine Opposites filter is active, arrowhead colours instead reflect **flipped share** (tail=cause, head=effect).

Automatic highlighting:

- Factors that match filters like Factor Label or Path Tracing show dashed coloured borders.
- Factor border colour reflects mean incoming edge sentiment (but when Combine Opposites is active: average flipped share, blue→red).

Interactive Features

These work for all layouts except Print/Graphviz layout (which is mostly for static export, but does support clicking nodes/links now).

- **Drag factors** to temporarily reposition them
- **Drag factor to factor** to create new links
- **Shift+drag** for box selection of multiple factors (opens edit modal)
- **Ctrl+drag** for box selection of multiple factors (direct selection, no modal)
- **Click a link** to edit.
- **Click a factor** to edit; shift-click or ctrl-click to add to selection without opening modal.

Editing and deleting (multiple) factors

- Select factor(s) by clicking a factor, shift-click or ctrl-click to add more, or shift+drag/ctrl+drag a box around multiple factors, then:
  - Move selected factors together
  - Delete matching factors everywhere or in current view only
  - Rename matching factors everywhere or in current view only

What does "everywhere or in current view only" mean?

- **everywhere**: all links containing factors with exactly the selected labels will be deleted
- **in current view only**: all links containing factors with exactly the selected labels (and matching the current filters, i.e. those you can see in the current map) will be deleted

💡 Tip: By control-clicking or shift-clicking multiple factors you can easily rename several at once, e.g. you can merge multiple factors as a single factor.

Grid layout

What this is for: Sometimes you want factors to appear in a rough **grid**—like “this cause is clearly to the left of that one”—instead of leaving the layout algorithm to guess. You do that by putting a small **coordinate tag** in the factor label (anywhere in the text). The app reads the tag to place the box, and (by default) hides the tag so respondents don’t see a string of numbers.

This is especially useful when:

- your factors fit logically into some kind of positional story like a theory of change and you want to keep them there
- you are showing many different versions of a larger map (e.g. districts within a country) and you want them to be more easily comparable.

How to write a tag: Use two whole numbers: a **column along the main flow** of the map and a **row** across the flow. For example `(2,1)` or `(2.1)` in the label means “second step along the story, first slot

across." You can use square brackets instead of parentheses, and you can leave one side blank if you only care about one direction—for example `(3,)` fixes the step along the flow but not the slot across.

In Map Formatting

- **Grid layout** — Turn this **off** if you want to ignore tags and let the map place everything as usual. It only appears when at least one factor in your current links actually has a tag. Default is **on**.
- **Strip grid tags** — Turn this **off** if you want to **see** the `(…)` or `[…]` text on the map. Default is **on** (tags still affect layout when **Grid layout** is on, but the numbers are hidden on the label). These two switches work independently.

Interactive map (the usual live map): tagged factors snap to a grid; anything without a tag is still laid out automatically, but is kept **near** the grid so the picture stays readable.

Print / Graphviz (static SVG): the app can't pin exact pixel positions like the live map, but it still respects **left-to-right order of the first number** along the direction you chose, and does its best to respect the second number **within** each step. If you only give a second number and not the first, Print layout can't place that factor on the "step" axis—use both numbers when you care about order.

Heads-up: The grid helpers only apply to the **default interactive** layout and to **Print**. If you switch the live map to layouts like **Cola**, **Circle**, or **CiSE**, coordinate tags are **not** used for placement.

Vignettes 🖉

📝 **What you can do here:** Generate AI-powered narrative summaries of your causal maps. Choose between a **whole-map** summary that covers the relationships in your current filtered view, or a **typical-source** story that focuses on one representative respondent. Useful for reports, annexes, and explaining your analysis in plain language.

For practitioners (getting started)

What are vignettes and why use them?
Vignettes turn your coded causal map into readable prose. After you have links (and usually quotes on those links), the AI can draft a narrative that names themes, tensions, and patterns in your material. You stay in control: you choose the prompt (tone, audience, structure), and you can edit the text afterwards. They are a fast way to move from "many links on a map" to "something I can paste into a report or share with stakeholders"—not a substitute for your judgement, but a structured first draft.

Whole-map vignette
Use this when you want a bird's-eye story of **everything that is currently in the map** (respecting your filters and source selection). The app sends a compact summary of factors and bundled links (with sentiment), **evidence snippets** (quotes and source IDs from highlighted bundles where available), and up to **30 "typical" sources** scored by how much they represent common bundles—each with bundles, link-level quotes, and a small **metadata preview** (title, filename, and simple custom fields). If you want

the narrative to emphasise particular edges, set **Map Formatting → Links highlight** to **Significant** or **Feedback loop** first; that snapshot is included so the model can focus there. **AI region** (where Gemini runs) follows **Project Details → AI region**, not a separate control on this card.

Typical-source vignette
Use this when you want a **single-respondent case study**: the app picks the most "representative" source for the **current** map view (using link counts and coverage of bundles, with a bias so very long documents do not always win). It sends that source's **full text** plus its links with quotes and sentiment, so the model can write as if telling **one** story. Do not ask it to generalise across the whole project in this mode—the prompt and data are scoped to that one source.

How to use (UI):

1. Open the **Vignettes** card on the Map side panel and expand it if needed.
2. Choose **model** (and optional **thinking** controls if your model supports them). **Region** for AI is set per project under **Edit project** (AI region), not on this card.
3. (Optional) Leave **Enable checking (second AI pass)** on so a checker can review the draft; notes appear in a collapsed panel when relevant.
4. Edit the **Whole-map prompt** and/or **Typical-source prompt** (prompt history: dropdown and prev/next; see tips on using prompt history).
5. Click **Write Whole-map Vignette** or **Write Typical-source Vignette** (two separate buttons).

Tip (optional): tell the AI which links matter most (whole-map mode):

- Go to **Map Formatting → Links highlight** and choose **Significant** or **Feedback loop**.
- When you run the **whole-map** vignette, the app includes a small snapshot of those highlighted edges so the model can focus on them.
- If **Links highlight** is **Off** (or **Reverse** only, with no edges flagged), or nothing qualifies, **no extra highlight list is sent**.

What each mode sends (summary):

- **Whole map:** Aggregated nodes/edges for the current view, optional **links highlight** snapshot, **bundle evidence** (quotes/source IDs sampled from top bundles so large projects stay within limits), and up to **30 typical sources** with bundles, per-link quotes, and compact source metadata —not the entire raw links table.
- **Typical source:** One chosen source's **full text**, its links with quotes and sentiment, simple node frequencies, and optional links-highlight context for that source.

Output format: Markdown (headers, bold, lists, blockquotes, code blocks). You can copy from the result area.

Bookmarking & restore:

- Each run saves a **bookmark** for the current view (description: `Vignette (whole|typical): <your prompt>`) and appends a link at the bottom of the vignette output.
- The bookmark footer includes the **model name** used.
- Vignette-related settings are stored in **URL state** where applicable (model, thinking, checking, prompts); project **AI region** lives in project metadata.